

Activating Minions

All Minions activate at the end of each Encounter phase, after the Stage Card has been resolved.

1. Minions will not activate if they have already been activated by the Stage Card during the Encounter phase.
2. Minions do not activate when body parts are broken and reaction cards are drawn unless the reaction card specifically states the minions are to be activated.

Minions are activated in order of the closest to their target first, according to the instructions in the minion box of the Special Rules Board. They follow the normal enemy movement and attacking rules, but choose targets differently than the Encounter. All Minions are moved before any of their attacks are resolved.

Minion Targeting

Minions do not share a target with the Encounter. Instead, they will target the closest Oathsworn, Ally or any character friendly to the Oathsworn that is in their Line of Sight. If two targets are equally distant and the minion has the Mob keyword, it will target the closest enemy who is already adjacent to another minion with the Mob keyword.

If there are no valid targets, the enemy will move as far as they can towards the closest Oathsworn, Ally or character that is friendly to the Oathsworn (whether they are in LoS or not) who is not excluded from being targeted for any reason, with ties broken using steps 4 and 5 on p19.

If minions are activated for any reason during a reaction, they do not automatically target the character that caused the reaction.

For example: The Priest and the Blade are both the same distance from the giant rat, however the Priest is already being attacked by another giant rat. Because they have the mob rule, the rat will move towards the Priest.



Mob Attacks

Enemies with the Mob keyword represent packs of smaller creatures that are not very powerful individually, but are dangerous when attacking together. When a character is attacked by one or more Mob enemies, use the total might of all of the Mob enemies attacking that character to determine the Might Cards drawn and resolve them as a single attack.

For example: 3 giant rats are attacking the Priest. A giant rat has 2 yellow Might Cards when attacking. Only one attack is drawn, using 6 yellow cards.

Some abilities and items let you interrupt attacks by forcing redraws or ignoring Might Cards. In the case of mob attacks, all Might Cards can be affected as long as at least one of the attackers are within range of the character attempting the interrupt.

Adding New Enemies

During an Encounter you may be instructed to place additional enemies on the board. If the hex where you would place the new enemy is occupied by either another character or an obstacle, place it in the closest unoccupied space while still attempting to follow the placement rules for that enemy and the rule of North then West.

When placing a large enemy, place the center of the model in the specified hex. Any other character in a hex that would be covered by the base of the model is pushed back (see *Pushed* on page 31). Any obstacle in a hex that would be covered by the base of the enemy is destroyed.

Change the facing of the newly placed enemy so that it is facing its target. If no target is defined by the effect which brought the enemy into play, use the rule of North then West.



END OF ROUND PHASE

Any effects which take place at the end of a round happen now.

Any cards which have an “until the end of the round” effect are discarded.

Ending the Encounter

An Encounter ends in one of two ways. Either the Encounter is defeated by removing all their HP dice from the Encounter Board or the Free Company is defeated when all **Oathsworn** go unconscious. If both events happen at the same time, the Encounter is defeated.

Success

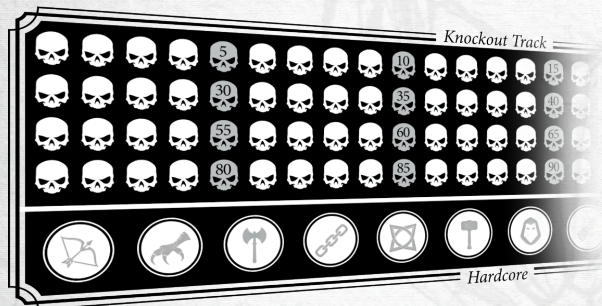
If you defeat the Encounter, the Encounter ends immediately and all remaining minions flee. Proceed to the Chapter Epilogue in the Story Book (found at the end of each chapter) or continue in the Companion App.

Failure

If you fail to defeat the Encounter (all Oathsworn go unconscious), you can either move on, or replay it.

Move on: Proceed to the Chapter Epilogue in the Story Book (found at the end of each chapter) or continue in the Companion App.

Replay the Encounter: Mark 4 ticks on the Knockout Track of the Free Company Sheet. Add two/one ticks if you played on Journeyman/Pilgrim Company difficulty and ignore one/two ticks if you played on Grim/Dread Company difficulty. This is your score for the Encounter regardless of future successes, you will not gain or remove any additional ticks on any future attempts.



For example: The first time you play the first Encounter on Free Company (standard) difficulty, all characters go unconscious; 4 ticks will have been marked on the Knockout Track. You choose to replay the Encounter and the second time only one character goes unconscious, so no more ticks are marked.

Additionally, if a character remains conscious during the replay of an Encounter they will not lose an additional item or gain an injury even if they went unconscious the first time.

To replay an Encounter, set it up as per the normal Encounter setup instructions (you do not replay the Story part) and follow these additional setup rules.

- Any Allies you started the Encounter with that were killed are returned to your Ally deck and not archived.
- All Oathsworn start with maximum Hit Points for that difficulty setting (even if they took damage during the Story part).
- All Oathsworn remove all Combat/Status Tokens on their Player Board and then gain any 3 Combat Tokens of their choice and also their Permanent Tokens as depicted on their Character Sheet.

Tally Level, Loot and Losses

At some point in the Epilogue you will be told to ‘Tally Level, Loot and Losses.’ When you are told to do this, perform the following in order:

Level

1. Gain 1 Level according to the Leveling Table on page 26.

Loot

1. Replace the **current** Item Deck in Card Organizer 1 with the Common Item Deck from the **next** chapter.
2. Gain 3 Common Items from the **next** chapter's Common Item Deck to share amongst your Free Company. *Note: whenever you gain items, you draw with the deck face down.*
3. Gain 2 Unique Items from the **current** chapter's Unique Item Deck to share amongst your Free Company (3 if your Free Company Sheet has this chapter extra Unique Item box checked). Gain 1 extra Unique Item if the difficulty is set to Grim Company or gain 2 extra Unique Items if the difficulty is set to Dread Company. If there are no more Unique Items, take a Common Item from the **next** chapter's deck.

4. Replace the **current** Unique Item Deck in Card Organizer 1 with the Unique Item Deck from the **next** chapter.

Losses

1. For each unconscious (dead if playing on hardcore mode) Oathsworn, mark one tick on the Knockout Track of the Free Company Sheet. Add two/one ticks if the difficulty is set to Journeyman/Pilgrim Company and ignore one/two ticks if the difficulty is set to Grim/Dread Company.
2. All unconscious Oathsworn gain an Injury Card from the Injury Deck. If playing Hardcore Mode, all Oathsworn with 1 or 2 Hit Points remaining also gain an Injury Card from the Injury Deck.
3. All Oathsworn lose 1 item they equipped in the Encounter (2 if they went unconscious), players choice. These items are archived back to their original item decks.
4. All dead Allies are archived.

SAVING THE GAME

Each character comes with a Character Save Bag and the Free Company as a whole has a Free Company Save Bag. When you have finished a play session, place the following into the Save Bags:

Each Character Save Bag

1. Your Character Sheet. If saving after the Story part of a chapter, record your current HP on it. If saving after the Encounter part of a chapter, do not record your HP. You return to your Maximum HP at the start of every Chapter.
2. Character Ability Cards. Separate unlocked and locked Ability Cards with a Character Card Separator.
3. The Companion Card and all Archetype Cards. Separate unlocked and locked Archetype Cards with a Character Card Separator.
4. The character's Injury Cards, Item Cards and Iron Coins.
5. Combat Tokens (only if saving between the Story and the Encounter, otherwise archive your Combat Tokens)

Free Company Save Bag

1. Free Company Sheet. If saving between the Story and the Encounter, record whether you will gain an extra unique item from the Time Track, have revealed the Encounter Special Rules Board and whether you are ambushed.
2. The Backpack Card and all Item Cards not equipped by any character.
3. Ally Cards
4. City and Deepwood Event Decks

After saving the game, archive all remaining components.

Additional Rules

Running Out of Components

The quantity of models and components is limited. If you are instructed to add one to the board and there are no more available, do not add more unless told otherwise (in which case, use something as a substitute). If using the Standee Version and you run out of plastic stands but still have available standees, play with the new standees laid flat rather than upright.

OATHSWORN LEVELS

All Oathsworn have a level signifying how powerful they are. Oathsworn begin the campaign at level 1 and, during the Epilogue of each chapter, will advance a

level after completing the Encounter.

The following table shows the bonuses the Free Company gains at each level.

Sometimes these bonuses are applied to each individual Oathsworn and sometimes they are a bonus for the Free Company as a whole.

Total character bonuses at that level

Level	Bonuses gained at that level	Permanent Tokens	Animus Regen / +2 Max Animus	Free Company Traits
2	Full Character: Ability Cards	1	0	0
3	Free Company Trait	1	0	1
4	All: Permanent Token	2	0	1
5	Full Character: Ability Cards Companion: Archetype Card	2	0	1
6	Free Company Trait	2	0	2
7	All: Permanent Token	3	0	2
8	Full Character: Increase Max Animus by 2 or Regen by 1 Companion: +2 Animus Token or Battleflow Token	3	1	2
9	Free Company Trait	3	1	3
10	Full Character: Ability Cards Companion: Archetype Card	3	1	3
11	Free Company Trait	3	1	4
12	Full Character: Increase Max Animus by 2 or Regen by 1 Companion: +2 Animus Token or Battleflow Token	3	2	4
13	Free Company Trait	3	2	5
14	All: Permanent Token	4	2	5
15	Full Character: Ability Cards Companion: Archetype Card	4	2	5
16	Free Company Trait	4	2	6
17	Full Character: Increase Max Animus by 2 or Regen by 1 Companion: +2 Animus Token or Battleflow Token	4	3	6
18	Free Company Trait	4	3	7
19	All: Permanent Token	5	3	7
20	Free Company Trait	5	3	8
21	All: Permanent Token	6	3	8

Quick Leveling and Swapping Oathsworn

At the start of each chapter, before the story part, it is possible to swap in and swap out the Oathsworn in your Free Company. This allows you to experience multiple characters throughout the campaign. Additionally, Oathsworn may die and need to be replaced or it is possible you may wish to play a specific chapter as a one-off game. The Quick Leveling System allows you to do all of these.

Quick Leveling

The level of every full character and companion being used in a chapter is the same as the number of that chapter. In order to 'Quick Level' an Oathsworn, refer to the Levels Table above and find the level you are about to play. Add all bonuses in that row to your character as well as unlock all Ability Cards or Archetype Cards for

your character of an equal or lower level. Then fully equip the character with items (two hand's worth of weapons, one armor and one gear card) from the Common Item Decks of any chapter that is lower than the Free Company's current level.

Note: If you are creating a new character after having died during the story, you cannot create another character of the same class as the one you just lost.

Swapping an Oathsworn Out

If you wish to swap out an Oathsworn (either a full character or a companion), first place all of their Iron and Injury Cards aside, then return their current Character Save Bag (along with its contents) to the box and take a new one. Quick Level your

new Oathsworn and give them the Iron and Injury Cards you set aside.

Swapping an Oathsworn Back In

To swap an Oathsworn back in that was previously swapped out, you first archive all of their items. Then, Quick Level that character, starting from their previously recorded level.

Swapping a Full Character to a Companion and Vice Versa

To swap a full character to a companion version or vice versa, take a new Character Sheet and Quick Level the chosen character. They keep the Item Cards and Injury Cards they already have and do not gain new items from the Quick Leveling.

Full Character: Ability Card

Each full character **unlocks all new Ability Cards of the character's level** from their pool of locked cards. The level of the card is shown under the card title. All Ability Cards the character does not start with are locked and must be unlocked to allow them to be used. Unlocking a new Ability Card does not automatically mean it is placed in your future hands of cards. It is just added to the pool of potential cards you can use when building your hand. Your maximum hand limit is **always 7 cards**. Locked and unlocked Ability Cards should be separated from each other in your Character Save Bag using your Character Card Separator.

Companion: Archetype Card

Each Companion **unlocks all new Archetype Cards of the character's level** from their pool of locked cards. The level of the card is shown on the left hand edge of the card. All Archetype Cards the companion does not start with are locked and must be unlocked to allow them to be used. Locked and unlocked Archetype Cards should be separated from each other in your Character Save Bag using your Character Card Separator.

Free Company Trait

Choose one of the Free Company traits and mark it on the Free Company Sheet.

Free Company Trait	Benefit
Bushcraft	Gain a redraw on Survival Checks.
Keen-Eyed	Gain a redraw on Spot / Search / Listening Checks.
Quick-Witted	Gain a redraw on Barter / Threaten / Reasoning Checks.
Endurance	Your Backpack can hold up to 20 items.
Quartermaster	Gain 1 Extra Ration at the start of every Deepwood Journey.
Scavenger	Loot 1 extra Common Item per chapter.
Herbalist	Gain 2 Curatives each time you purchase 1.
Tough As Nails	Add 1 Time Token to the Time Track to heal a character 1 HP who lost a HP during the story. Max once per chapter.
Field Medic	Add 2 Time Tokens to the Time Track to archive 1 Injury Card on a character. Max once per chapter.
True Grit	When you are forced to gain an injury, draw 2 Injury Cards, pick one and discard the other.
Comradery	Allies enter play with 2/3/4 Redraw or Empowered x3 Tokens.
Well-Connected	'Sending a Runner' to a BANKSMITH or APOTHECARY no longer costs any additional iron.

All: Permanent Token

Each full character and companion gains a new permanent token of your choice. Mark the chosen token on your Character Sheet. The token does not need to be the same for each character. Each character can have a maximum of 3 of each type of permanent token. This does not limit the amount of Combat Tokens a character can earn from other sources. Rules for permanent tokens can be found in the Story Rule Book on page 13.

Full Character: Increase Max Animus or Regen

Each full character increases either their maximum Animus by 2 or their Animus regeneration by 1. Mark the chosen bonus on your Character Sheet.

Companion: +2 Animus or Battleflow Token

Each companion gains a permanent +2 Animus Token or Battleflow Token. Mark the token on your Character Sheet. Remember that companions use +2 Animus or Battleflow Tokens differently. See page 9 for more details.

Bushcraft, Keen-Eyed & Quick-Witted

For each check mark, you gain a single free redraw on each check of the relevant type(s), up to a maximum of 3. Checks where each member of the Free Company performs the check count as individual checks. *Example, placing a check mark in Quick Witted gives you one free redraw on all Bartering, Threatening & Reasoning checks.*

Endurance

Flip over your Backpack Card. It can now hold up to 20 items.

Quartermaster

Gain 1 Extra Ration whenever you begin to use the Deepwood Journey Mechanism.

Scavenger

Loot 1 extra Common Item per chapter. This allows you to gain 5 rather than 4 Common Items when gaining loot after an Encounter.

Herbalist

Gain 2 Curatives each time you purchase 1. This applies every time you purchase Curatives from an Apothecary.

Tough As Nails

During the Encounter setup, each Oathsworn may choose to roll an unused Hit Point Die. Whoever rolls highest, regains 1 lost HP.

Field Medic

You may pay X iron (Where X is your current chapter number) to archive 1 Injury Card on a character. This trait may only be used once per chapter and only on a single character. This trait may be used immediately when gained.

True Grit

Whenever any Oathsworn would draw an Injury Card, draw two instead and pick one to keep. Return the other to the Injury Deck and shuffle it.

Comradery

Allies enter play with 2/3/4 Redraw or Empowered x3 Tokens (or any combination of the two). These are chosen when each Ally enters play and may be different for each Ally.

Well-Connected

'Sending a Runner' to a BANKSMITH or APOTHECARY, as described on page 15 of the Story Rule Book, no longer costs any additional iron.